

AEC 4623: Global Marketing of Agricultural Products

Dr. Ayoung Kim
Associate Professor
Agricultural Economics, Mississippi State University

Syllabus: Spring 2027

Course Info

3 Credits
In-person Lecture or Online
(for Campus 1 and 5 students)
Website: canvas.msstate.edu

Contact Info

E-mail: a.kim@msstate.edu
Office Hours: Email at any time
or Video meeting by appointment
Virtual Meeting Room in Webex:
<https://msstate.webex.com/meet/ak1896>

* Disclaimer: This syllabus is subject to change. Students will be notified of any minor revisions, which will be posted on Canvas. (last updated on 09/21/2026)

Course Description

This course introduces students to some of the basic concepts of international trade, the political economy of trade in agricultural products, trade policies, and current issues. This course will focus on 1) a brief overview of the microeconomic theory of international trade; 2) the effects of government intervention in international agricultural markets; and 3) current issues in international agricultural trade.

Prerequisites

Students are not required to have previous knowledge or training in the theory or applications of international trade. However, students should be familiar with a basic understanding of introductory microeconomics and macroeconomics and comfortable using basic mathematical skills, equations, and graphs.

Course Website

Course materials, including lecture notes and/or videos, readings, quizzes, answer keys, discussions, and other instructional materials, will be available through Canvas. Course materials and

announcements will be posted on Canvas according to the course schedule. Announcements will be posted on the class board. You are responsible for ensuring that 1) you can access Canvas and 2) there is no technical issue with receiving an email. We also suggest you check the announcements and updates regularly. If you cannot access Canvas, contact instructors as soon as possible for assistance.

Technology Requirements

You will need a computer with access to the high-speed Internet. Additionally, you will need the following:

- Chrome or Firefox Browser
- Adobe Acrobat Reader ([download here](#))
- (not required but useful) CamScanner (free phone scanner app to create PDF) or any similar app that you find useful

Use of Generative AI

Generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT or similar technologies) may be used as a learning aid for reviewing concepts, checking understanding, or exploring alternative explanations. However, all submitted work must reflect the student's own economic reasoning and understanding. Students must be able to explain and justify their analysis using the concepts, models, and terminology covered in this course. Submissions that rely on generic, overly polished, or formulaic explanations that do not align with course materials, lecture examples, or required economic models may receive reduced credit or no credit. The instructor reserves the right to ask students to clarify or explain their submitted work if the originality or understanding is unclear.

Communication

Students may communicate with the instructor by email, during office hours, in person, or through scheduled virtual meetings, depending on the delivery format. I aim to respond to all inquiries within 24 hours, except on weekends, when responses may take longer. Course Announcements will be posted on Canvas, and you will receive email notifications through the university email system. If your question may also benefit other students and is not personal in nature, please use the FAQ Board on Canvas and post your question using threaded replies.

Course Materials and Resources

- Steven S. **Suranovic**, International Trade: Theory and Policy (Open-license textbook)
<https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks/textbooks/international-trade-theory-and-policy>
- Other readings will be assigned from various news articles, journals, books, and research bulletins through Canvas.
- Not required, but for students who want more reading

- James P. Houck, Elements of Agricultural Trade Policies, Waveland Press, Inc 1992
- Michael R. Reed, International Trade in Agricultural Products, Prentice Hall, 2001

Learning Goals & Objectives

The general purpose of this course is to provide a sound understanding of international economics and agricultural trade. The learning objectives are to 1) gain proficiency in theories of international trade; 2) understand trade policy; and 3) apply our training to understand major economic issues and problems. By the end of the course, students will be able to:

1. identify key issues in international trade and use economic tools to analyze them
 - develop an understanding of, and analyze the economic consequences of tariffs and subsidies on domestic and foreign markets
 - evaluate the impact of exchange rates on agricultural trade
2. analyze and solve problems using concepts such as
 - Comparative advantage
 - Partial equilibrium models
 - Producer and consumer surplus in welfare analysis
3. analyze economic arguments made about trade policy
4. integrate and effectively communicate the concepts learned in the course

Delivery Format

This course may be offered face-to-face or online. Both delivery formats cover the same course content, address the same student learning outcomes, and maintain equivalent academic requirements and expectations. Differences between the formats relate primarily to the mode of instruction, communication, and student interaction. Online students access course materials and instructional activities through Canvas and communicate with the instructor and other students electronically and/or through scheduled virtual meetings.

Assessment of Goals

Goals will be assessed using weekly quizzes, biweekly discussions, and a final project. Students will also be given graphical models and other exercises that require mathematical calculations to assess their understanding of the various theoretical concepts taught in class.

Course Requirements and Grading

Evaluation of Performance: Students can earn a total of 400 possible points in this course. Bonus points may be available for selected discussion activities and are not included in the total points below. Your final course grade will have the following benchmarks out of the 400 possible grade points.

Weekly quizzes (14 quizzes; lowest 2 dropped)	
Best 12 quizzes (12 at 15 points)	180 points
Biweekly Discussions (7 at 20 points)	140 points
Final Project: Trade policy and market analysis	80 points
Total	400 points

Grading scale: A = 90-100%; B = 80-89%; C = 70-79%; D = 60-69%; F = 59% and below

Weekly quizzes: There are 14 weekly online quizzes in this course. Each quiz is based on the lecture materials for that week and is completed individually. The lowest two quiz scores will be dropped, and only the best 12 quiz scores will count toward your final grade. Quizzes are open-note and will be available for one week. Students are responsible for completing each quiz by 11:59 p.m. CST every Sunday.

Biweekly Discussions: There are seven online group discussions in this course. Each discussion is worth 20 points and will be completed in assigned groups, which will be randomly assigned. Discussions will take place approximately every two weeks. For each discussion, students are expected to post one original contribution and respond to at least one group member. Discussions will be graded according to the rubric provided. Please refer to the rubric file available on Canvas for grading criteria. Students will have two weeks to complete each discussion. Bonus points may be awarded for discussion participation. In each discussion, up to 2 bonus points may be awarded to the student in each group whose post receives the highest level of peer engagement (e.g., likes), as determined on Canvas. Students are responsible for completing each discussion by 11:59 p.m. CST on the posted due date (typically a Sunday at the end of the two-week discussion period).

Final Project: Trade Policy Analysis For the final project, students will analyze the economic impacts of a trade policy (e.g., a tariff, import ban, or quota, as selected by the instructor) affecting an agricultural product market. The analysis should examine how the policy influences the market, with a focus on its effects on supply, demand, and prices in the agricultural product market. Students must also evaluate changes in economic welfare, including impacts on consumers, producers, and overall social welfare. The project should be grounded in economic reasoning and use the concepts and tools covered in this course, such as supply and demand analysis, welfare analysis, and trade policy effects. Students are expected to clearly explain the economic mechanisms through which the policy affects the market, rather than relying on descriptive or opinion-based arguments.

Late Submission: Late submissions will be accepted with a 20% deduction from the earned score. Submissions more than one week past the deadline will receive a score of zero.

Grades & Review: All graded work will be returned within one week of the assignment date, and scores will be posted online (Canvas). If mistakes are made in grading, or if you have questions about my evaluation of your quizzes, discussions, or final project, please bring them to my attention as soon as possible. Make an appointment for a review within **one week** after your work has been returned to you. After one week without review, your grade will stand as given.

Academic Misconduct: Academic honesty is expected. This means that cheating and plagiarism will **NOT** be tolerated. If discovered, you may receive a zero for the quiz, the discussion, the final project, or other affected assignment. Continued disregard for this policy could result in an "F" grade for the course. All students are expected to be familiar with the Student Honor Code (see Policies on page 6).

Tentative Course Outline

Date	Topic	Textbook: Suranovic
January	Course overview Introduction to international trade Trade in agricultural products Guest lecture 1	Ch. 1
February	Absolute and comparative advantage Review of fundamentals of economics Trade and welfare	Ch. 2
March	Trade policy effect Protection policies: import & export Tariff & World equilibrium Tariff effect in a small economy Analysis of Tariff effect Guest lecture 2 & 3 Pure exchange model	Ch. 7
April	The Ricardian model of international trade Relationship between prices & wage International trade and specialization Market Planning Tools International Market Entry Strategies Guest lecture 4	Ch. 2

Key Dates

January 13	Class Begin
January 20	Last day to drop a course without a grade (11:59 pm)
January 21	Last day to add a course (5:00 pm)
March 4	Last day to drop a course with "W" grade (5:00 pm)
Week of March 8 (March 8-14)	Spring Break - No lecture

University Policies

Generative AI

Mississippi State University recognizes the introduction of generative artificial intelligence (generative AI) provides opportunities for scholarly rigor, intellectual integrity, and educational excellence. Nevertheless, the use of generative AI also poses issues related to academic integrity. Currently, individual instructors are encouraged to establish class-specific guidelines concerning the use of generative AI within their courses. The student must consult the syllabus for each class they are taking to determine if and to what degree generative AI is allowed.

Disability Resource Center

Mississippi State University is committed to providing equitable access to learning opportunities for all students. The Disability Resource Center (01 Montgomery Hall) collaborates with students who have disabilities to arrange reasonable accommodations. If you have, or think you may have, a disability, please contact drc@saffairs.msstate.edu or [662-325-3335](tel:662-325-3335) to arrange a confidential discussion regarding equitable access and reasonable accommodations. Disabilities may include, but are not limited to, conditions related to mental health, chronic health, attention, learning, autism, brain injury, vision, hearing, mobility, speech, or intellectual disabilities. In the case of short-term disabilities (e.g., broken arm), students and instructors can often work to minimize barriers. If additional assistance is needed, please contact the Disability Resource Center. For more information, visit <https://www.drc.msstate.edu/>.

Student Honor Code

Mississippi State has an approved Honor Code that applies to all students. The code is as follows: "As a Mississippi State University student, I will conduct myself with honor and integrity at all times. I will not lie, cheat, or steal, nor will I accept the actions of those who do." Upon accepting admission to Mississippi State University, a student immediately assumes a commitment to uphold the Honor Code, to accept responsibility for learning, and to follow the philosophy and rules of the Honor Code. Student will be required to state their commitment on examinations, research papers, and other academic work. Ignorance of the rules does not exclude any member of the MSU community from the requirements or the processes of the Honor Code. For additional information, please visit: <http://honorcode.msstate.edu/policy>

Title IX

MSU is committed to complying with Title IX, a federal law that prohibits discrimination, including violence and harassment, based on sex. This means that MSU's educational programs and activities must be free from sex discrimination, sexual harassment, and other forms of sexual misconduct. If you or someone you know has experienced sex discrimination, sexual violence and/or harassment by any member of the University community, you are encouraged to report the conduct to MSU's Direction of Title IX/EEO Programs at [325-8124](tel:325-8124) or by email to titleix@msstate.edu. Additional resources are available at [Dean of Students Sexual Misconduct and Sexual Assault](#).

Mandatory Reporting

Faculty members at Mississippi State University are required to report any information received about possible sexual misconduct. This includes information shared in class discussions or assignments, as well as information shared in conversations outside class. The purpose of reporting is to allow MSU to take steps to ensure a safe learning environment for all. The university also has confidential resources available, who can provide assistance to those who have experienced sexual misconduct without requiring a mandatory reporting duty. Students may access confidential campus resources here: [Office of Civil Rights Compliance - Title IX and Sexual Misconduct](#).